QP CODE: 24900135

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - MG1DSCHIS100 - INTRODUCING HISTORY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Part A

Short Answer Questions
Answer any 10 questions.
Each question carries 2 marks

1) Distinction in Definition, Scope, Sources, Purpose- Past- events and occurrences before the present moment- sequence of occurring- independent of human recording- static and unchanging. History- systematic study and interpretation- selective- subject to reinterpretation
2) Historical Sense- ability to understand and interpret past by placing them in appropriate context- Causality- Critical Analysis- Look for relevant examples.
3) Royal touch as a symbol of power and legitimacy- medical and cultural context- Marc Bloch
4) Marc Bloch- French Historian- Annales School- Social, Economic and Cultural aspect of History
5) Anthropology- Scientific study of human cultures, behaviour, societies and their development over time
6) Historical Imagination- ability to mentally reconstruct the past- contextualising- emphaticising- taking perspective- engagement with evidence- critical thinking.
7) Hermeneutical thinking- theory and methodology of interpretation- interpretative process- analysing text to understand their meaning in specific context- role in deepening understanding of primary sources- critical assessment of secondary sources- connecting historical texts to broader societal and cultural narratives

8) Date Mining- extracting patterns and insights from large data sets- employment of statistical and computational techniques.
9) "Technology and the Historian: Transformations in the Digital Age"- Adam Crymble- scope of digital technologies in historical research.
10) Photographs- visual evidence to people, culture, events and environment of the past- unique role in providing historical insights- photographs and context.
11) India Today- 1940- Marxist analysis of India's colonial history, socio-cultural transformation and nationalist movement.
12) Local History- focuses on the uniqueness (social, economic, cultural) of specific geographical areas, communities and regions- role in uncovering micro history.

Part B

Short Essay Type Questions
Answer 6 questions.
Each question carries 5 marks

13) Primary and Secondary Sources- Category of historical evidence- role in studying history- Primary Sources- features and role in understanding history- Secondary Sources- dependability on context, analysis and interpretation- Differences in historical thinking and objectivity- Complementarity of Primary and Secondary Sources
14) Marc Bloch- a product of his period- the Annales and new historical perspective- History as a science- temporality of history- centrality of human actions- call for interdisciplinarity- allied disciplines- disadvantages- exclusionary implications, challenges of objectivity.
15) History as a therapeutic touch- role of history in building identity and providing belongingness- role in confronting historical wrongs- role in developing perspectives- building collective resilience.
16) Key features of critical thinking- essentiality of critical thinking- historical source and critical thinking- critical thinking and fostering of curiosity and questioning mentality- importance in contextualisation- source evaluation- comparison, contradiction and generalisation- role in interpretation- identifying change and continuity
17) Historical significance of everyday histories- study of daily life, ordinary people, routine activities- importance in the fabric of society- importance in understanding lived experiences- socio cultural, emotional aspects of society- role in humanising history by integrating the life of ordinary people- broadening historical perspective- enriching historical source materials- understanding change and continuity- exploring social dynamics, power and relationships- role in challenging dominant narratives

18) GIS in history- HGIS- role in mapping, analysing and interpreting historical data with spatial and temporal precision- ability to integrate historical data with geographic information- role in understanding the relationship between space and history- mapping historical changes over time- impact of environment and climate- social and economic structures- digital narratives
19) AI in historical studies- availability of innovative tools to identify patterns, analyse vast data and uncover insights- change in method of analysis, interpretation and engagement with historical data- use of methods like machine learning, natural language processing and data mining- role in digitizing and analysing historical archives- image recognition- predictive modelling and simulation- enhancing public engagement-
20) Role of theory in history writing- crucial role in providing frameworks that guide interpretations- causes, connections and implications- role in uncovering patterns- assumption- ensuring in-depth analysis- comparative and interdisciplinary approaches- role in guiding research question and methodology
21) Importance of Objectivity in History with examples by Thapar- objectivity as unbiased, balanced and evidence based analysis and presentation of history- role of objectivity in promoting accuracy, preventing misuse, facilitating critical thinking, encouraging pluralist understanding- Role of Thapar as an objective historian- how Thapar used history to critique myths, legends, preconceived notions, and biases such as Aryan conquest of the indigenous Indian population, Oriental Despotism, the other worldliness of in Indian culture, and prevented history from being a tool for political myth making.
22) K N Panikkar's Against Lord and State- written in the context of Peasant and Religious Uprisings during the 19th and 20th Centuries- focus on the complexity of affiliations of the rebels- interrelationship between economic dissent and religious ideology- extensively use of primary sources, popular culture and oral tradition- emphasis on the role of ideology and the development of negative class consciousness.

Part C

Essay Type Questions

Answer 2 questions.

Each question carries 10 marks (In Question paper marked wrongly as 15)

23) Compare and Contrast the definitions of History- How their times have influenced these historians in defining history- Carlye and his great men theory- history as shaped by extra ordinary individuals- Bloch and history as the science of men in time- Annales school- emphasis on multi-faceted aspects of history- temporal and social contexts- interdisciplinarity and the role of allied disciplines-

Carr and history as an unending dialogue- subjectivity vs objectivity in history- role and importance of facts

24) Significance of archives, libraries and museums- importance of sources in writing history- role of archives, libraries and museums as foundational institutions- role beyond mere repositories of past- role in providing contextual understanding of the past- engagement with diverse materials- role of material evidence- sites of memory- visual learning- everyday history

25) Nora's argument on the fundamental difference of memory and history- weakening of organic memory and the need for documentation- Realms of Memory Vs. Sites of Memory- memory as organic and lived experience, subjective and experiential- History as constructed, objective and distant- detachment of perspective- impact of modernity and break with memory- need for sites of memory- Nora provides an insight into modernity, especially the alienation caused- holistic understanding into how societies engages with the past- Nora limits from emphasising the intersectionality of memory and history- Eurocentric- disregard non-western societies where collective memory and historical practice coexist-reshaping of memory and history in digital era.

26) Thapar's idea of scientific method- emphasis on rigorous methodology, evidence-based enquiry and critical engagement with sources- emphasis on verifying narratives- critical scrutiny of historical facts- role of allied disciplines in writing history- opposition linear and simplistic narration of history-evolution of history with the availability of new sources.